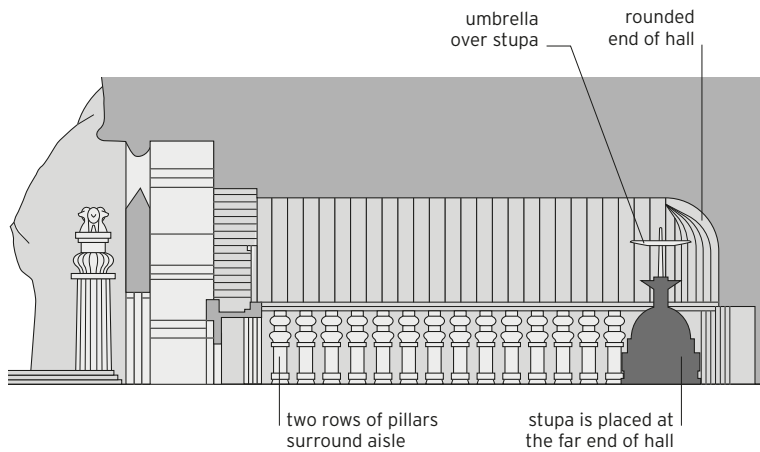


CHAITYA

A chaitya is a Buddhist shrine or prayer hall with a stupa at one end. The end of the hall is usually rounded to allow devotees to circumambulate the stupa. Such halls are typically high, long, and narrow and have a vaulted ceiling with prominent ribbing. Many early chaitya were carved out of rock, and the ribbing was decorative rather than structural.



CATHEDRAL A Christian church that serves as the seat of a bishop and the central church for an administrative region, or diocese. Cathedrals tend to be larger than the average church. *See also church.*

CEILING The overhead surface covering a room.

CEILING JOIST *See joist.*

CELLA The inner chamber of a temple in Classical Roman architecture. It usually contained a statue of the deity to whom the temple was dedicated. *See also adyton, Classical.*

CEMENT A binding agent used to make concrete. Cement has been used since ancient times. Modern cement is made by heating limestone with other materials, such as clay, to high temperatures and then grinding the resulting material.

CENOTAPH A memorial monument erected in honor of a person or persons whose remains are elsewhere.

CENTERING The timber framing used to support an arch or dome while it is under construction.

CHAIR-RAIL A molding fixed horizontally around the walls of a room at roughly waist height. Originally, it was intended to protect the wall from being damaged by furniture, but in modern rooms, it is used for decorative effect. It is also known as a dado rail. *See also dado.*

CHAITYA *See panel, above.*

CHAITYA ARCH An ornamental arch used to decorate a facade, often placed around or above a doorway. The design of the arch is based on a cross-section of a chaitya and looks like an upturned ship's hull with a keel and ribbing. *See also chaitya.*

CHALET A timber house characteristic of Switzerland, Bavaria, and the Alpine regions, with a shallow, sloping roof and wide eaves. Originally, chalets were the dwellings of shepherds. *See also eaves.*

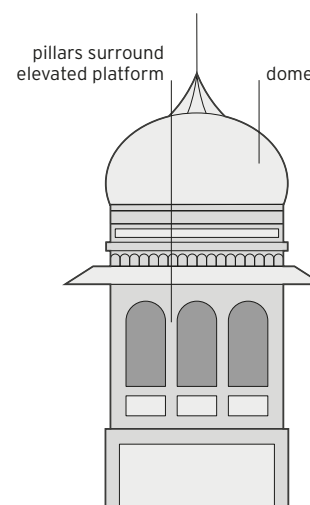
CHANCEL The area where the altar is located at the end of a nave. It is the area used by the clergy during worship. *See also altar, church, nave.*

CHANTRY CHAPEL An endowed chapel in which a priest was employed to sing regular masses for the chapel's founder. It was believed that such masses would speed the deceased's soul to Heaven. Chantry chapels were abolished during the Protestant Reformation (16th century).

CHAPEL A Christian place of worship that does not have a parish attached to it. Chapels can be free-standing but are more commonly part of a larger structure such as a cathedral, castle, college, palace, or hospital. *See also cathedral.*

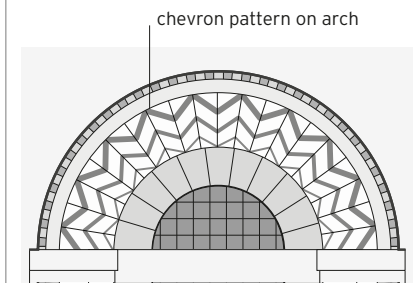
CHARNEL HOUSE A vault or building in which human skeletal remains are kept.

CHATRI ▼ A small, domed pavilion supported by columns at each corner. *Chattris* are used to adorn the corners of a roof or placed above the main entrance in Indian Mughal architecture. They are decorative and have no function. *See also Mughal.*

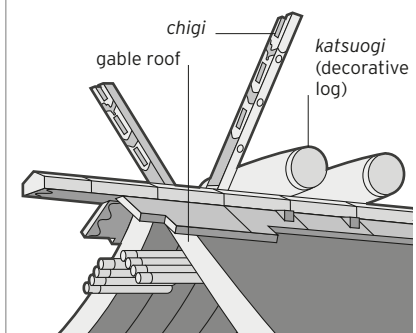


CHEQUER-WORK A design of alternating squares that resembles a chessboard.

CHEVRON ▼ An inverted V-shape. In Norman architecture, it is used to form zigzag patterns on arches and columns.



CHIGI ▼ Forked roof finials found in Japanese architecture. *See also finial.*



CHIMNEY-BREAST The part of a chimney that projects forward into a room with the fireplace set into its base.

CHIMNEY SHAFT A high chimney stack with only one flue (duct leading up to the roof).

CHIMNEY-STACK The part of a chimney that projects above the roof.

CHINOISERIE A European decorative style inspired by art and design from China, Japan, and other Asian countries. The name comes from the French word for Chinese, *chinois*.

CHOIR The part of a church or cathedral that provides seating for the clergy and church choir. Choirs are commonly located in the chancel. *See also chancel, church.*

CHULLPA An ancient funerary tower of the Aymara, an indigenous people of the Andes and Altiplano regions of South America.